Respondent	Trainer	
Interview Date	August 16, 2023	
Duration	12:01 minutes	
Language	Filipino	
Questions	**Answer**	**English Translation**
In your opinion, does social media help Filipino workers feel better when they experience depression symptoms?	Para sa akin po facebook, messenger, Instagram, TikTok, Youtube, siguro madami pang iba-ibang pero ayun nga pwede mong magamit, pwede po nating magamit pag nalulungkot ka. Pag ako po kasi pagnalulungkot ako halos sa facebook. Pag nalulungkot ako, pag nasasaktan ako doon po ako tumitingin sa facebook.	For me, it's facebook, facebook messenger, Instagram, TikTok, YouTube and maybe there's still other social media that they can use when they feel lonely. If I feel lonely and hurt, I usually use and view feeds on facebook.
• Do you think these social media usage helps them?	Yes nakakatulong po sya kasi for example ayun nga kung gusto natin makausap ang mga pamilya natin sa Pilipinas pwede nating matawagan kung gusto natin kung anong nangyayari sa bansa natin pwede nating Makita yung mga nangyayari, mga news	Yes, when they feel lonely. For example, if they want to talk with their family in the Philippines, they can just call. They can do the same if they want to know about the news in the Philippines or whatever is happening.
• Do you know any Filipinos in	Yes, actually lahat po sila gumagamit po ng facebook para matawagan nila mga asawa nila, mga pamilya	Yes, actually most of them use facebook to call their wives, their family and to know information about the

your company who use these social media?	nila para makibalita sila sa ano sa bansa natin.	Philippines.
What are the social media platforms that you can suggest to the Filipino workers when they feel depressed?	Para sa akin facebook, TikTok, YouTube mga ganun. Pwede nilang gamitin yun kasi sa mga social media kasi yun young may nakikita po tayong masasaya pagmalungkot ka makakapag patuwa sayo kaya doon din po ako pagnalulungkot po ako dun din ako tumitingin. Actually madalas po ako sa Tiktok kasi parang nakikita ko sila na sumasayaw, natutuwa ganunkahit malungkot ako sumasaya ako.	For me, facebook, TikTok, and Youtube- these kinds of social media platform. They can use these social media platforms because they can see happy videos when they feel sad. It may give them happiness. If I feel lonely, I view videos on these platforms. Actually, I usually use TikTok to view dance videos and I feel happy if I watch it.
• So, you can also suggest to the filipinos that they can use TikTok?	Pwede. Kasi yung TikTok uso na rin sa Pilipinas. Pwede mo siyang pagkitaan at pwede rin makakilala ka ng mga tao.	Yes, they can. TikTok is now popular in the Philippines. You can also earn money in TikTok and be able to meet people.
If you can suggest, how can social media be utilized in the workplace in relation to depression symptoms of workers?	Parang dito po kasi sa japan , hindi ko alam, sa trabaho ko kasi may break time kami ng 10:15 tsaka 3:15, alas 10 at alas 3 may 15 minutes kami na break time at sa tanghali 12 to 1 pm may isang oras po kaming breaktime so magagamit po naming ang social media facebook nanunuod kami ng TikTok ganun.	In my opinion, I don't have any idea because in my workplace in Japan, we have a 15 minutes break time- 10:15 and 3:15 and during lunch from 12:00-1:00 pm, so we have one hour where they can use their social media, use facebook, or do TikTok.

Do you have other ideas on how social media can help Filipino workers when they feel depressed?	Pwede din kumita at pwede din natin sa social media mag kakilala yung ibang tao.	They can earn from their social media through monetization and they can also use it to meet other people.
• Like doing vlog for example?	Pwede bang magvlog? Ako kasi isa akong TikToker na nagsisimula palang akong nag la-live sa TikTok.	I'm also a TikToker but I'm still new in doing live.
How can you relay to the management about this concern of suggestion?	Ako kasi isa akong half Japanese-half Filipino so marunong akong mag Japanese at marunong din akong magtagalog. Actually, angginagawa ko ditto andami ko din mga kasamang Pilipino so andami din na hindi marunong mag Japanese so ako yung madalas na mag translate sa mga boss. So, kung may Nakita akong ganun na tao na depressed, tutulongan ko sya na sabihin at sabihin ko sa boss ko na may depression ang isang Pilipino.	Since I am half-Japanese and half-Filipino, so I can speak both Japanese and a little Tagalog so I can understand them. Actually, most of the Filipinos in my company are not fluent in speaking Japanese so I usually do the translation to our boss. However, if I see someone who is depressed, I help them by relaying it to our boss that someone is depressed.
• So, you help him through telling it to your boss?	Sasabihan ko sya. Makakatulong ako sa pagpapaliwanag at translate.	I can help the Filipinos by translating and explaining to our boss if they experience depression.
• Does your company do something if	Meron yung iba kasi ditto sa japan madami din ang mga depressed. Isa din ako siguro duon. Ngayon na parang pupunta nga hospital. Sa mga balita madami	There are many cases of depression among Japanese workers here in Japan. I think I'm one of them. There are always news that there are a lot of people

someone would tell that he/she is depressed?	yung mga balita na nagpapakamatay ditto sa japan kahit high school dahil yun sa mga depress depress kaya nga parang ina-ano sila sa mga hospital para i-check up. Parang i-refer sila sa isang hospital or doctor or mental health expert.	committing suicide even high school students because of depression. So, if someone is depressed, we can refer them to hospitals or mental health expert for checkup.

Respondent	Company HR
Interview Date	August 16, 2023
Duration	23:35 minutes
Language	English
Questions	**Answers**
In your opinion, does social media help Filipino workers feel better when they experience depression?	Yeah, I think so. For example, I see in our company, like all of them they have family in the Philippines so I can see for example the lunchtime they can talk with their family by social media and they can talk with them every day. Also, they can make friends with some other guys. Maybe, in Philippines, facebook is the most used right over than Instagram? Even when I meet some Filipino from other companies, then we meet for one day, they like add me. Also, in TikTok even at work we can talk. I think social media helps a lot. It is a good way to be more close to their family and friends especially they are away. Maybe, it is now better. Even in Japan, that is a very technological country, like when I arrived here 20 years ago, it was pretty different. So,

	we just have a telephone. For example, you have to buy telephone cards and it was like sen yen (1,000 yen) and you can only speak for 1 hour to call for your family. So, now you pay nothing and you can speak for a long time. Also, you can see like a video chat as long as you have a Wi-Fi connection.
What are the social media platforms that you can suggest to the Filipino workers when they feel depressed?	Maybe, facebook. They use it the most. In my situation, the most user like in Brazil is Instagram, maybe Japan is LINE or in the Philippines its WhatsApp. So, it depends. Maybe, they feel comfortable about that. Also, it is better to keep using facebook and maybe try another app. That's up to them.
• I also noticed here in Japan not all people use facebook?	It is more Instagram I think so. Instagram is, maybe recently, like two-3 years ago started like this boom from Instagram. Even Japan almost don't have a social media like facebook or Instagram. Maybe they don't feel comfortable about sharing somethings. Maybe the younger (Japanese) have compared to the older (Japanese).
• Do you have Instagram?	Yeah, I have but I don't use it often but I have facebook and I use it sometimes only.
If you can suggest, how can social media be utilized in the workplace?	Maybe, but for us like we are not a big company. I think we are just a small company so maybe we can make a page or like a facebook page. But for now, we are not trying to hire other guys instead of Filipinos because it is more easy to handle and to talk to. So yeah, maybe we can create a facebook page or Instagram page or something but maybe it will not change something.

• How can you use social media to help Filipinos who are depressed in your workplace?	In my case, it is because we are connecting in the facebook so that's the only way that I can talk with them outside work because they don't have a telephone number and they don't have a number so they only use facebook. That's the only way that me or my boss can talk with them, only with the facebook.
• You're becoming friends with them on facebook so that you can communicate?	Not only in the facebook but also daily and being together. So, facebook helps with that. For them, their main project to come here is to work, to make money and like send back to their family. Some of them, they building places and they send all their money. For me, it's the same because I am a leader so I think the same way. For example, I saw that they like to go out, they like to meet, see new places but on the other hand they cannot spend so much money so our boss allows us to use the company car in the day off to take them, to go somewhere, to take pictures and they like to share, they like to posts new places. It's cool because maybe their family wants to see that they are going very well here also. They are not just working hard but also enjoying a life. Like in this holiday, we are planning to go to the USJ but some of them don't want to spend because in the holiday the tickets are more expensive. So, I talk with the boss if he can help us some stuff like that. For them, it will help a little bit-not just work-stay home and work-stay-home. They do something different but not every week because it's very hard and stressful to be just at home and maybe just only staying and talking to their family. It is good for them to go out and do something different. So, when I have time or chance, I take them somewhere because I know it's hard only if they just work and work. That's it.
Do you have other	I don't think so because they use to keep in touch with their family, to share things, post pictures and talk

ideas on how social media can help Filipino workers when they feel depressed?	also. They can comment on their friend's stuff. Maybe, it's not because it's foreigner or Filipino. I wish that all the foreign workers, too. They could make more contact or socialize more with Japanese. So maybe it's not their fault. Maybe, it's on the other hand's fault because we still live here and maybe there are still some people who are very late and they have some kind of racism maybe. Even for me, sometimes. Maybe, I think if they would make more contact, they would do socializing with the Japanese, it's gonna be great because Filipino culture is very rich I think even for food so maybe share to some Japanese-cultural sharing. They come here so they get introduced to the Japanese culture not on the other hand. It's good because Philippines is not too far from Japan. Maybe, that is a good idea if they can do it.
How can you relay to the management about this concern or suggestion?	Maybe, if they feel depressed, I think social media will not help something about it because they are using every day so maybe it will not help that. But maybe I work with Filipinos with 4 or 5 years and in our case, we never have some Filipino with depression, no cases. We have other problems but this like depression or something mental, we don't have experience.
• If ever they will speak to you about depression, will it be fine with you?	Maybe, I think maybe our company will try to find a hospital or something. We have problem with the Japanese workers also with Brazilians, also me, not depression but stress problem. So yeah, maybe for me I think, if they use social media every day it will not help them with something.

Respondent	Prefectural Adviser
Interview Date	August 11, 2023

Language	English
Questions	**Answers**
In your opinion, does social media help Filipino workers feel better when they experience depression?	I think social media is a double-edged sword. While my short answer is yes, it can, my full answer is that it can also perpetuate and increase sensations of isolation and separation from home. Social media allows foreigners in Japan to feel connected to others, they can both highlight how much is happening in their home communities that they're missing out on, and present a rose-tinted image of what other foreigners in Japan are experiencing. Very few foreigners in Japan post about difficulties they are having, or feelings of isolation or depression, so their friends walk away with the feeling that nobody else has those problems.
What are the social media platforms that you can suggest to the Filipino workers when they feel depressed?	Hmmm, I can't say I would specifically recommend any BECAUSE someone is depressed, but I do generally feel everybody in Japan should have LINE. Although the PH community in Japan is vibrant and tightknit, for building relationships with Japanese people, LINE is basically mandatory!
If you can suggest, how can social media be utilized in the workplace?	This naturally differs from workplace to workplace. Personally, I think the most important thing is for employers to do away with the old-fashioned idea that using phones in the workplace (at least office style workplaces) is a sign of being non-productive. I think the most important thing social media can be used for in the workplace is building connections with your peers, especially the ones you don't share a physical space with. If an employee has a robust support network they can fall back on, that is something that is invaluable, and allowing employees to establish and develop those networks in the workplace is quite useful.
Do you have other ideas on how social	Simply being able to connect to people who love you, or people who are struggling the same as you, or who have struggled the same as you, are the most useful things social media can do at times like that.

media can help Filipino workers when they feel depressed?	
How can you relay to the management about this concern of suggestion?	In all honesty, entities like the BoE are not going to be particularly easy to convey this to. In general, Japan is extremely poor at handling mental health, especially in the workplace, and I don't think using social media is something they're going to have much interest in as a solution for that. Instead, I feel the two main ways to approach any Japanese leadership is by pointing out how social media a) has productivity benefits, and how it's ability to create support networks ultimately help their employees stay more engaged at work and b) by leaning on the inter-cultural elements of social media, and how it can be useful for ensuring foreigners stay connected to their cultures.

Respondent	Former City Deputy Secretary
Interview Date	August 11, 2023
Duration	9:00 minutes
Location	City Office and email
Language	English
Questions	**Answers**
In your opinion, does social media help Filipino workers feel better when they	It is easy to imagine that every migrant worker, not only from the Philippines but also from other foreign countries, struggles with the language barrier in a foreign land. This is one of the main reasons why some become depressed.

experience depression?	So, social media will definitely be a strong ally for all of them.
• Why do you think so?	Social media is a nice tool to express their feelings, talking concern to others, get others to listen. This makes them feel better.
What are the social media platforms that you can suggest to the Filipino workers when they feel depressed?	I only know of e-mail and Skype, but I think the tools they are familiar with are preferable. Social media will be a strong method for depressed people to feel better.
If you can suggest, how can social media be utilized in the workplace?	Officially, foreign workers would have to rely on the means prescribed by the workplace (company, business place), though, some workplaces may not even available to support them, in which case they may have to do so privately outside working hours. ※ It would be nice if there is a way for employees to make a request to employers, but I suspect that in many ways the environment is not yet conducive to this everywhere. ※ The quality of the intermediaries, not only employers but also the sender's or the receiver's, may deeply be involved for workers' circumstances. I have to say that government will not enter into areas related to various private sector troubles.
Do you have other ideas on how social media can help Filipino workers when	For example, an official response to address a migrant worker's depression has not been laid down in the city of Imabari, and that would be difficult. Basically, administrative body, not only Imabari but also any city and even the prefectural administrations, do not have such organizational structures.

they feel depressed?	It's the personal matter and the issue belongs to a business place. If this is the case, what avenues are open? Filipino trainees devise and create their own networks, and their movements get some public support, for example, from the ICIEA in Imabari City, their efforts may lead to expand their circle of consultation and support. ※ It's up to the ICIEA's cooperation and response, but I'm not sure. Because, even if they try to consult with the city, administration will not be able to response. ※ My understanding and view might be wrong, but I suppose migrant workers are in a sense isolated and cannot look to existing public or quasi-public support systems. Therefore, it is necessary for them to open the way to help each other voluntarily. Educated people can easily get network. But for most of the workers who are under the Trainee program, it is hard for them. Not only for Filipinos but for other nationalities as well.
How can you relay to the management about this concern of suggestion?	As mentioned earlier, it is therefore crucial that the workers themselves make an effort to expand their personal networks, and a new horizon may open up from such activities. It's tough, but I think that's the reality. **‘Use social media well, because it is a super power modern weapon for you guys that was unthinkable in the past.’** Everybody should try to change their situation by themselves. Administrative body has no measure to deal with it. For example, Kocho-sense (Principal) will listen to your feelings, he will not be able to respond directly. No effective response. He will not get any help from administrative body.

Respondent	ICIEA Staff
Interview Date	August 28, 2023
Language	English
Questions	**Answers**
In your opinion, does social media help Filipino workers feel better when they experience depression?	In my opinion, social media doesn't help people who are experiencing depression. Maybe it will make them feel sad when they keep using it.
What are the social media platforms that you can suggest to the Filipino workers when they feel depressed?	I don't believe that social media is a good idea to use when people feel depressed, not only for Filipino workers but in general as well, to all foreigners in Imabari. Maybe, YouTube.
If you can suggest, how can social media be utilized in the workplace?	Social media should be introduced by the company or project for work-related purposes. For example, promoting an event you can use it.
Do you have other ideas on how social	Listening to music or finding something interesting that can make themselves feel better may be helpful. As foreigners, they are lonely so they can use social media to feel better.

media can help Filipino workers when they feel depressed?	
How can you relay to the management about this concern of suggestion?	In my case, I can consult their problems at the city's counseling center.